

# Pre-Solicitation Window Guide

This guide shows you how to use the 30 to 60 days before an RFP drops to position your company for a win.

**What it is.** This is the critical window after an agency releases a pre-solicitation notice, but before the final Request for Proposal (RFP) comes out. It's usually 30 to 60 days. What you do in this period often decides if you win or lose the bid.

**When to use it.** Start here the moment you see a pre-solicitation notice on [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov) or an agency's forecast. This guide helps you act fast and smart during that specific window, before the official bidding clock starts ticking. Don't wait until the RFP is live.

## How to use it.

- Open the "Pre-Solicitation Playbook" file in this folder first.
- Register for and attend any pre-bid or industry day conferences the agency hosts.
- Draft and submit smart questions. Remember, the agency's Q&A responses are public and can shape the final RFP.
- Finish up any last-minute capture activities, like teaming agreements or key personnel identification, before the RFP drops.

**Watch out for.** Many firms just skim the pre-solicitation and wait for the RFP. That's a mistake. You're giving up your best chance to influence the terms and show the agency you're paying attention.

Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/pre-solicitation> Next step: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/bid-no-bid> (Bid / No-Bid Decision)